

Editing Sample: Before & After

Technical Editing — Internal Communication

Skill Demonstrated: Clarity editing, tone, structure

Original Text

"Employees should try to submit their expenses on time because if they don't then finance might not be able to process them and this could cause delays and confusion."

Revised Version

Employees must submit expenses within five business days to ensure timely processing. Late submissions may result in delays or require additional verification from Finance.

Notes on Improvements

- Replaced vague language ("should try to") with a clear requirement ("must").
- Added a specific timeline (five business days) in place of an open-ended deadline.
- Improved tone and professionalism by removing conversational hedging.
- Strengthened readability and structure by shortening the sentence and removing the run-on "because...and this could" chain.

Second Example: Internal Announcement

Original Text

"Hi all!! just a reminder that starting next month basically everyone is going to need to start using the new system for time off requests instead of emailing your manager directly so please make sure you check it out before then because IT said the old process won't really be supported anymore!!"

Revised Version

Starting September 1, submit all time-off requests through the new PTO system instead of emailing your manager. The previous email process will no longer be supported. Log in and review the new workflow before then.

Notes on Improvements

- Replaced the vague deadline ("starting next month") with a specific date.
- Cut filler phrases ("just a reminder," "basically," "please make sure you check it out") that added length without adding meaning.
- Split one long run-on sentence into three short, direct sentences.
- Removed hedging ("IT said," "won't really be supported") in favor of a direct statement of the policy.
- Removed excessive exclamation points to establish a calmer, more professional tone appropriate for a company-wide announcement.